HOT ROD FANTASY FOOTBALL BOYS

Week 4 Breakdown

The Rundown Week 4

🏆 **High Scorer of the Week**
Lewis — 147.10 pts | 11–0 All-Play
One week after posting the league's lowest score at 75.04, **Lewis** flipped the script with 147.10, the highest total of Week 4 and a season-best performance for his team. His 72.06-point turnaround was enough to beat **Brett** by 19.42 and even his record at 2-2.
The breakout also came from the manager who leads the league in season-long lineup accuracy at 95%. **Lewis** has been making the right lineup decisions all year, but Week 4 was the first time his roster truly delivered. Despite the explosion, he remains ninth in PF and 17-27 in all-play. One big week hasn't erased the slow start, but it may have changed the direction of his season.

🍀 **Lucky Break**
Bryan — 90.96 pts | 2–9 All-Play
Bryan managed to escape Week 4 with a win despite posting the third-lowest score of the week. His 90.96 would have lost to nine of the league's other 11 teams, but he drew **Castano's** 81.86 and improved to 2-2.
The bigger picture is even more remarkable. **Bryan** sits at just 7-37 in season-long all-play, tied for the league's worst mark, yet has managed to win half his actual matchups. He ranks 11th in points scored, and both victories have come when he finished in the bottom quarter of the league's weekly scoring. If there's a team making the most of its schedule, it's **Bryan**.

🎲 **Not So Lucky**
Kyle — 109.90 pts | 132.42 pts | 9–2 All-Play
For the second straight week, **Kyle** finds himself earning the Not So Lucky distinction. After losing by just 1.78 points in Week 3 despite going 6-5 in all-play, he followed it up with an even stronger performance that somehow produced the same result.
Kyle posted the third-highest score of Week 4 at 132.42, but ran into **John's** 144.78. His score would have beaten nine of the league's other 11 teams and now stands as the highest losing score of the 2026 season, replacing **Dawson's** 127.92 from Week 2. **Despite** sitting at 2-2, **Kyle** ranks fifth in total PF and holds a 27-17 season-long all-play record. Two consecutive weeks of above-average scoring have resulted in two losses, leaving **Kyle** with a record that doesn't quite reflect his performance.

🪑 **Bench Blunders**
Brett & Ed — Two Wins Left on the Bench

Brett: In a week where **Lewis** exploded for 147.10, Brett had the answer sitting on his bench. Brian Robinson Jr. scored 25.20 points while Rashee Rice delivered a zero in **Brett's** FLEX spot. Making that one switch would have turned his 19.42-point loss into a 152.88–147.10 victory, giving **Brett** the week's highest score instead of **Lewis**.

Ed: The margin was much smaller, but the regret was just as real. **Ed** lost to **Hannah** by 5.34 points while starting Dontayvion Wicks (3.30) over KC Concepcion (8.90). That 5.60-point improvement would have flipped the result to 105.18–104.92, keeping **Ed** undefeated at 4-0.

🎯 **Sharp Shooter**
John — 100% Week 4 Lineup Accuracy
John didn't leave a point on the table in Week 4, earning a perfect 100% lineup accuracy score while producing 144.78, the league's second-highest total. He defeated **Kyle** by 12.36 and moved to 3-1, extending his winning streak to two games.
The performance also pushed **John** into a tie with **Derrick** for the league's best season-long all-play record at 32-12. With 93.3% lineup accuracy across four weeks, he ranks second behind **Lewis**, combining strong roster decisions with one of the league's highest-scoring teams.

Around the League

The Middle Has Never Been More Crowded

Four weeks into the season, 10 of the league's 12 teams are sitting at .500 or better, the most through Week 4 in the modern era. Four teams are 3-1, six are 2-2, and only **Dawson** and **Castano** remain winless. With so little separation in the standings, a single Week 5 result could dramatically change the playoff picture.

Week 5 Is the First Major Playoff Checkpoint

History suggests the fifth game is where early-season records begin carrying real weight. Since 2021, teams starting 4-1 or better have made the playoffs 15 of 16 times (93.8%), compared with just 50% of teams at 3-2 and 38.9% at 2-3. All four current 3-1 teams have an opportunity to reach that historically favorable mark this week.

The Schedule Is Creating Two Different Standings

The gap between actual records and all-play performance is becoming difficult to ignore. **Derrick** leads the league in scoring with 510.98 points and shares the best all-play record at 32-12, yet sits just 2-2. Meanwhile, **Bryan** has managed the same actual record despite scoring only 363.06 points and going 7-37 in all-play. Both teams have won twice, but their underlying performances could hardly be further apart.

Two Teams Enter Uncharted Territory

Dawson and **Castano** are the league's only 0-4 teams, a start no manager has recovered from to reach the playoffs in the modern era. **Dawson** has scored 382.26 points but faced 481.76, while **Castano** has produced a league-low 350.96. However, with a record ten teams sitting at .500 or better and the middle of the standings unusually crowded, there may be an opportunity for an unprecedented comeback. Neither team is far behind the pack just yet, but they'll need to start winning quickly before that gap becomes too much to overcome.

Week 5 | The First Major Playoff Checkpoint

Lewis (2-2) vs. John (3-1)

John enters Week 5 tied for the league's best all-play record at 32-12, while **Lewis** is fresh off a league-high 147.10-point performance. A win would give **John** his first 4-1 start of the modern era and put him in a group that has historically made the playoffs 93.8% of the time. **Lewis**, meanwhile, can climb above .500 for the first time this season after scoring just 251.48 points through the opening three weeks.

Ed (3-1) vs. Brett (2-2)

Ed's undefeated run ended last week, but he remains tied for the league's best actual record despite ranking eighth in PF and going just 20-24 in all-play. **Brett** presents a difficult test, ranking third in PF with a 31-13 all-play record. A win would move Ed to 4-1 and strengthen his playoff position considerably. **Brett** can move to 3-2 and prevent a second straight loss from pushing him below .500.

Bryan (2-2) vs. Josh (3-1)

Josh has won three straight games and ranks second in PF, while **Bryan** has somehow reached .500 despite a league-worst 7-37 all-play record. The contrast is striking: **Josh** has scored 121.78 more points through four weeks, but **Bryan** is only one game behind in the standings. **Josh** can enter the historically favorable 4-1 group, while **Bryan** has an opportunity to turn an unlikely 2-2 start into a winning record.

Castano (0-4) vs. Hannah (3-1)

Two teams with very different starts meet in Week 5. **Hannah** is enjoying her best opening four games in the modern era and can reach 4-1 for the first time. **Castano**, meanwhile, is still searching for his first victory after producing a league-low 350.96 PF. No team in league history has recovered from an 0-4 start to reach the playoffs. Another loss would leave **Castano** at 0-5 with just nine regular-season games remaining.

Derrick (2-2) vs. Wayne (2-2)

Last season, **Derrick** finished tied with **Bryan** for the league's best regular-season record at 11-3, while **Wayne** went on to capture the 2025 championship. Now both enter Week 5 at 2-2, with very different paths to that record.
Derrick leads the league with 510.98 PF and shares the best all-play record at 32-12, while Wayne sits sixth in PF with a 25-19 all-play record. The winner moves to 3-2, a mark that has historically produced a 50% playoff rate. The loser falls to 2-3, where that rate drops to 38.9%.

Dawson (0-4) vs. Kyle (2-2)

Dawson is still looking for his first win, while **Kyle** is trying to escape back-to-back weeks of bad matchup luck. **Kyle** has gone 15-7 in all-play over the past two weeks but lost both actual matchups, including a 132.42-point performance in Week 4. **Dawson**, meanwhile, is coming off the lowest score of the season at 73.92. A win would put **Kyle** back above .500; a loss for **Dawson** would extend his winless start to five games and make an already difficult playoff recovery even more unlikely.

Historical playoff rates after Week 5:
4–1: 93.8% | 3–2: 50% | 2–3: 38.9% | 1–4 or worse: 8.3%

2026 RECORDS

High Score:
150.18 — Derrick, Week 3

Lowest Winning Score:
82.86 — Ed, Week 2

Highest Losing Score :
Kyle, 132.42 (W4)

Closest Match:
0.04 pts — Ed over Bryan, Week 2, 2026

Historical Records

High Score:
211.78 — Lewis, Week 14, 2024

Lowest Winning Score:
57.88 — Juan, Week 1, 2023

Highest Losing Score :
155.54 — Brett, Week 8, 2024

Closest Match:
0.04 pts — Ed over Bryan, Week 2, 2026

Draft Capital vs. Production

BY THE NUMBERS

How Much Are Your Top Two Picks Delivering?

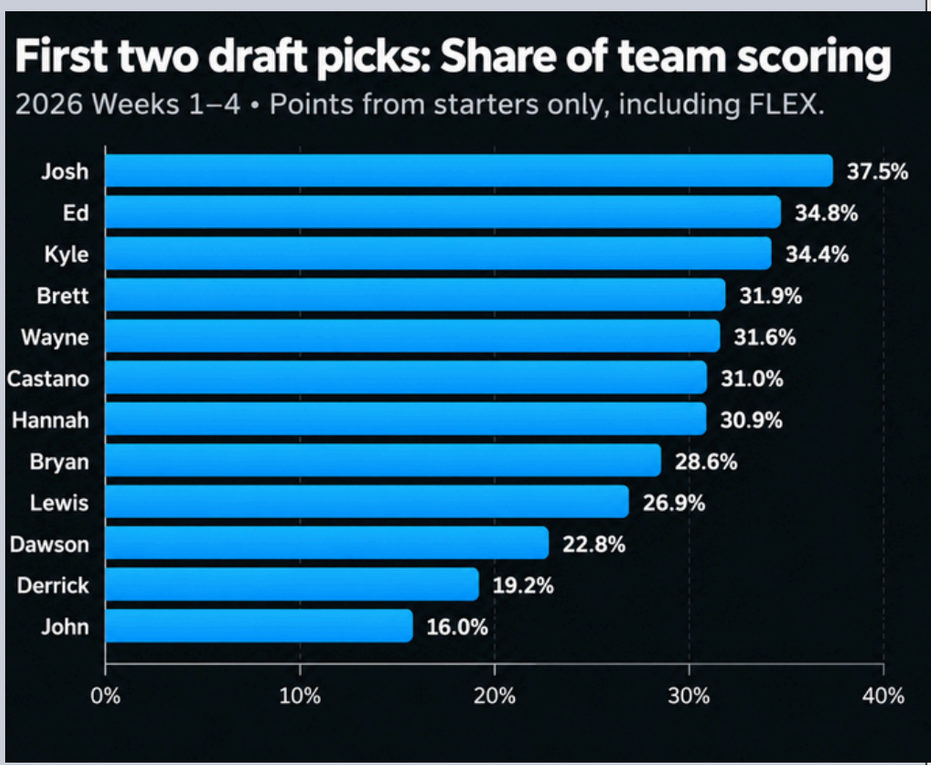
37.4%
Josh leads the league with 181.36 points from his first two draft picks, Jaxon Smith-Njigba and Kyren Williams.

3 OF 4
Three of the four highest-scoring teams **(Derrick, Josh, Brett and John)** receive less than 32% of their production from their first two draft picks. **Josh** is the exception at 37.4%, the league's highest share.

2 TEAMS
Only **John (16.0%) and Derrick (19.1%)** receive less than 20% of their scoring from their first two selections, yet both rank among the league's top four in total points scored.

16.0%
John has received the lowest share of team scoring from his first two selections, Puka Nacua and Jeremiyah Love, despite sitting 3-1.

7 TEAMS
Seven of the league's 12 teams have received at least 30% of their total scoring from their first two draft picks.



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WEEK 4 STORYLINES

2026 WEEK 4

The Draft Picks Aren't Carrying the Leaders

John and Derrick rank last and second-to-last in first-two-pick scoring share at just 16.0% and 19.1%, respectively. Yet **John** sits 3-1 and fourth in total PF, while **Derrick** leads the league in scoring. Both have found ways to produce without relying heavily on their biggest draft investments.

Josh Is Getting What He Drafted

Josh has received a league-high 181.36 points from Jaxon Smith-Njigba and Kyren Williams, accounting for 37.4% of his season scoring. That early-round production has helped fuel a three-game winning streak and a 3-1 start in his debut season. Unlike **John** and **Derrick**, **Josh's** biggest investments are doing much of the heavy lifting.

Investment Doesn't Always Equal Results

Josh's first two picks have contributed 104.36 more points than John's, yet both managers enter Week 5 at 3-1. Meanwhile, **Castano** has received 31.0% of his scoring from his first two selections but remains 0-4. Four weeks in, a high percentage of production from early-round picks hasn't necessarily translated into wins.

Two Teams, Two Very Different 2-2 Records

Derrick and Bryan share identical records, but almost nothing else. **Derrick** leads the league with 510.98 PF and a 32-12 all-play record, while **Bryan** ranks 11th in scoring at 363.06 PF with a league-worst 7-37 all-play mark. That's a 147.92-point scoring difference between two teams with the same record, a striking example of how much weekly matchups can shape the standings.

Lewis Finally Breaks Through

After three weeks of struggling offensive production, **Lewis** exploded for 147.10 points in Week 4, completing a 72.06-point turnaround from his league-low 75.04 the previous week. He remains the league leader in lineup accuracy at 95%, suggesting his early struggles weren't primarily caused by poor lineup decisions. Now 2-2, **Lewis** has an opportunity to build on his breakout as the season moves into its first major playoff checkpoint.

Depth Is About to Be Tested

With NFL bye weeks beginning in Week 5, roster depth is about to become a bigger factor in the playoff race. Managers will need to navigate missing starters, injuries, and increasingly important FLEX decisions. Teams that have relied heavily on their first two draft picks could face tougher decisions when those players are unavailable, while deeper rosters may have an opportunity to separate themselves. With ten teams entering the week at .500 or better, the ability to find reliable production beyond the starting stars could make all the difference.